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King Abdulaziz University
Faculty of Engineering
General Courses Unit – IE200

Mission Statement

The mission of the General Courses Unit is to empower Faculty of Engineering students by equipping them with advanced English proficiency and communication skills, crucial for achieving academic excellence and fostering distinguished professional careers in engineering.

General Objectives

The course is aimed at developing the students' communication abilities in English. Students of the Faculty of Engineering are required to engage in various situations that require specific verbal, textual and technical ability.

In addition to oral abilities, the course aims for students to enhancing their reading, writing, presentation skills, thinking and technical communication skills. This is achieved by using the research process as a vehicle of language and communication development. The course provides students with the tools to complete background and in-depth reading, design research tools, conduct research, write reports and make recommendations based on the research. The course aims to extend the students' use of spoken English at the upper Intermediate and advanced levels, through exploring contemporary issues.

Course Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of the course the students should be able to:

1. Demonstrate verbal communication skills in various situations.
2. Demonstrate written communication skills in specific subject matters.
3. Identify and produce elements of report writing corresponding to the AIMRAD research model.
4. Define a clear and concise research proposal about a contemporary issue and forecast the work to be addressed
5. Analyse quality, validity and accuracy of information from a variety of sources.
6. Analyse, interpret and apply qualitative data to develop and support a research topic.
7. Apply citations to support the credibility and authenticity of the information presented.
8. Demonstrate knowledge of terminology in relation to the research process.
9. Maintain and produce a portfolio demonstrating organisational skills as well as a reflection on learning.

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Course Book

1. **GET INTO IT - IE200 Communication Skills 2025 – Authored by GCU**
2. **Handouts, videos, online resources**

Course Structure

1. This is a fifteen-week course with ten hours of instruction per week i.e., 150 instructional hours.
2. The course will focus mainly on speaking, report writing and presentation skills. Listening and reading skills are also developed by introducing students to various reading material and activities as well as videos with specific subject-matters.
3. An overall grade of 60% is needed in order to pass IE200 (with no less than 40% grade in any of the Computer-based tests)

Flipped Classroom

IE200 will make use of the 'Flipped Classroom' model as much as possible. A 'Flipped Classroom' requires students to watch videos, recorded lectures and do exercises off class in order to prepare for specific practical in-class activities.

Attendance Rules

1. Students who have 25 % (or more) unexcused absences will be assigned a DN regardless of their final grade.
2. 1 period is defined as 1 fifty-minute session. 1 absence is defined as missing 1 period. The course consists of 150 periods.
3. Students are expected to be in class on time and ready to participate fully in the lesson including clear active participation during online synchronous classes.
4. Students who arrive more than 15 minutes late to class will be recorded as absent for that period.
5. Students who arrive more than 5 minutes late but less than 15 minutes after class starts will be recorded as late. 2 late cases will equal 1 absence.
6. If a student is absent, he must provide a valid excuse to his teacher for that lesson **within 3 days** of being absent. The absence excuse document must be **approved and stamped by the Student Affairs Unit**.

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Student Portfolio

Organization is an important aspect of academic life, and more so of professional life. Therefore, it is of extreme importance that students of IE200 keep all of their work in an organized manner by maintaining a portfolio. The portfolio is to be maintained from the beginning of the course and not halfway through or just at the end and must be readily available and accessible at all times. The portfolio will be checked and assessed regularly during the semester.

Each section of the portfolio is to be clearly labeled and separated using dividers. The portfolio contributes towards the final grade. It must showcase the student's work and growth during the whole semester in an easy-to-follow and transparent manner and must include as much teacher feedback as possible.

As to the format and structure of the portfolio, please check with your teacher and refer to the relevant rubric.

Assessment

The assessment in IE200 is generally formative and performance-based to enable the student's continuous learning and growth working closely with teacher and classmates and benefiting from continual feedback. Students will be informed of their progress consistently throughout the course. Assessment will also be continuous and will focus mainly on what students are able to produce as opposed to what they know.

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Assessment Breakdown

ASSESSMENT	WEIGHTING
Writing Tasks	15
Speaking Activities	15
Mid Term Test	10
Topic Negotiation	5
Presentations: (Introduction & Methodology 10%; Final Defense 10%)	20
Introduction and Methodology Write Up	5
Results & Discussion (+ Conclusion) Write Up	10
Final Exam	10
Portfolio	5
Final Report (+Abstract)	5
TOTAL	100

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Late Submission Penalties

Self-regulation, planning, time-management and the meeting of deadlines are part of the personal and professional skills expected of all engineering students. For this reason, IE 200 students are expected to submit all coursework and presentations by the published deadline date and class-time (See Pacing Guide) after which penalties will be applied.

For coursework submitted after the published deadline the overall grade is reduced by 10 percent points per each working day from the overall grade allocated to that work, not from the student grade.

(Eg.1. Student Grade 8/10: student gets 1 point reduction for each working day. For example, if the work is submitted two working days late, the final mark will be 6/10)

(Eg.2. Student Grade 3.5/5: student gets 0.5-point reduction for each working day. For example, if the work is submitted three working days late, the final mark will be 2/5)

If the coursework is received more than five working days after the published deadline, the student gets a mark of zero.

Academic Integrity

Students are expected to maintain academic integrity throughout the E200 course.

Academic dishonesty, including but not limited to cheating, plagiarism, and/or any form of academic dishonesty, will be met with strict disciplinary action.

Academic dishonesty may include, but is not limited to:

- 1. Cheating:** The use of unauthorized materials or resources (especially A.I) during an exam, assignment, or assessment.
- 2. Plagiarism:** Deceptively presenting another person's work, ideas, or writing as one's own.
- 3.** Any other form of academic dishonesty that provides students with an unfair advantage during exams, assignments or assessments.

Consequences for Academic Dishonesty

First Offense: Mandatory zero (0) for the task or assessment in question, with written warning.

Repeated Offense: Referral to the disciplinary committee, which may result in removal from the course or further academic penalties as determined by university policy.

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Course Outline and Rules Acknowledgement

I have read, understood and agreed to the following important points regarding the IE200 course:

1	Unjustified absences over 25% will result in DN	
2	Being 15 minutes late for a class results in 1 class hour absence	
3	Being 5 minutes late for a class results in 1 LATE. 2 LATES = 1 Class hour absence	
4	Cheating / Copying / PLAGIARISM will be taken seriously and would lead to the likely removal from the course. I understand and agree to the rules related to academic integrity	
5	I must complete all assignments within the deadlines assigned. Late submissions result in 0 grades or deducted marks	
6	I must complete all writing and speaking tasks in the first 6/7 weeks in the class time for those tasks. If missed, a zero grade will be given	
7	I must complete all 'Flipped Classroom' activities that my instructor as	
8	I must not score less than 4 out of 10 in both computer-based exams. Failing to waive this defect in a subsequent Exam means failing the whole course.	
9	Once enrolled in IE200, I am committed to completing the course and will by no means request to withdraw from the course or change the class.	

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Section: 1

Date: _____